

Theoretical Framework

A **theoretical framework** is a collection of theories and concepts used by a researcher to explain a research problem, guide the study, and understand the results.

In project report writing, it gives a **strong academic base** for the project and helps the researcher conduct the study in a proper way.

Objectives of Theoretical Framework

The main objectives are:

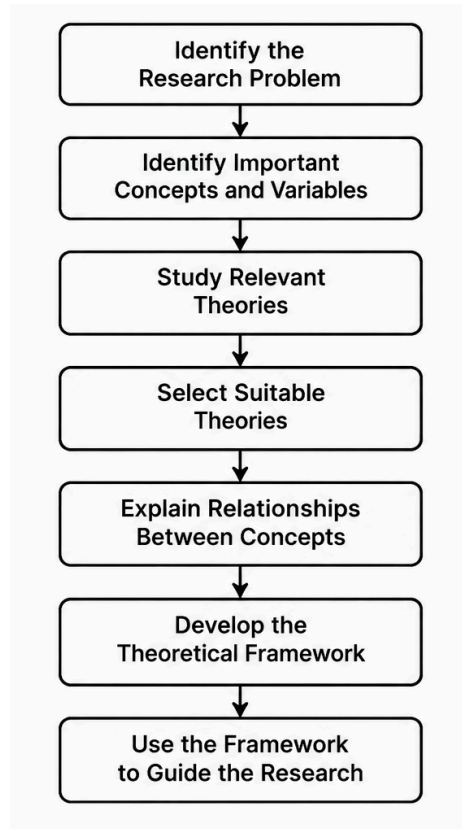
1. **To provide a theoretical base** for the project.
2. **To explain important concepts** used in the study.
3. **To identify relationships** between different concepts or variables.
4. **To guide research questions and objectives.**
5. **To help select suitable research methods.**
6. **To help analyze and understand the results.**
7. **To connect the present study with existing knowledge.**

Main Components of Theoretical Framework

Component	Simple Meaning
Key Concepts	Important ideas or terms used in the project.
Relevant Theories	Existing theories related to the project topic.
Variables	Factors that can change or affect each other.
Relationships	Connection between different concepts or variables.
Research Context	The situation or area in which the study is conducted.

Steps to Develop a Theoretical Framework

The theoretical framework can be developed using the following steps:



1. Identify the Research Problem: First, clearly identify the problem that the project wants to study.

2. Identify Concepts and Variables: Find the important ideas and factors related to the research problem.

3. Study Relevant Theories: Study existing theories that can explain the research problem.

4. Select Suitable Theories: Choose the theories that are most closely related to the project.

5. Explain Relationships: Explain how the concepts or variables are connected to each other.

6. Develop the Framework: Arrange the theories, concepts and relationships in a clear structure.

7. Use the Framework: Use the framework to guide data collection, analysis and interpretation.

Example

Consider a project on **“Effect of Online Learning on Student Performance.”**

The important concepts may include:

- Online learning quality
- Student engagement
- Study time
- Academic performance

This means that **better online learning may increase student engagement and study time, which may improve academic performance.**

The relationship can be shown as:

